

**DEPARTMENT SEVEN
JUDGE TIM P. KAM
707-207-7307
TENTATIVE RULINGS SCHEDULED FOR
FRIDAY, AUGUST 28, 2026**

The parties may appear via Zoom with the exception of trials, trial management conferences, order for examinations and mandatory settlement conferences. The information for the Zoom meeting is set forth below.

The tentative ruling shall become the ruling of the court unless a party desiring to be heard contacts the judicial assistant of the department hearing the matter by 4:30 p.m. on the court day preceding the hearing, and further advises that such party has notified the other side of its intention to request a hearing. A party requesting a hearing must notify all parties of the request to be heard by 4:30 p.m.

**REGIONS BANK vs. JOEBEL PAULITE
Case No. CL24-04726**

Motion to Summary Judgment filed by Plaintiff

TENTATIVE RULING

THE PARTIES ARE TO APPEAR.

At the hearing, the Court's tentative ruling is as follows:

The unopposed motion is granted, as Plaintiff has presented evidence to show Defendant was loaned money by Plaintiff, agreed to repayment over time, and then defaulted on those payments. [See Declaration of Trena Farr, ¶¶3-13].

While summary judgment is granted, as to the principal amount of \$12,125.62 still owed on the lending agreement, and the prejudgment interest claimed in the amount of \$3,664.00, the amounts claimed for court costs and attorneys fees cannot be included within the summary judgment. Those amounts must be claimed in post-judgment papers, per CRC 3.1700 [costs] and 3.1702 [attorneys fees].

**BANK OF AMERICA N.A. vs. STELLA MALL
Case No. CL25-06057**

Motion by Defendant to Set Aside Default and Default Judgment

TENTATIVE RULING

THE PARTIES ARE TO APPEAR.

At the hearing, the Court's tentative ruling is as follows:

A proof of service for a summons that complies with statutory requirements creates a rebuttable presumption that service was proper. 1 Edmon & Karnow [Weil & Brown], Civil Procedure Before Trial (The Rutter Group 2025), §4:362, p. 66. “A declaration of service by a registered process server establishes a rebuttable presumption that the facts stated in the declaration are true.” 1 Edmon & Karnow [Weil & Brown], Civil Procedure Before Trial (The Rutter Group), §4:367, p. 66, citing Evidence Code §647.

One of the manners of service authorized for summons and complaint is substituted service. C.C.P. §415.20(b) authorizes substituted service by delivery if a copy of summons and complaint to the dwelling place of the person intended to be served, leaving it “in the presence of a competent member of the household or a person apparently in charge . . . at least 18 years of age”, and thereafter mailing another copy to that same address, addressed to the person intended to be served.

Plaintiff has submitted evidence of valid substitute service. (Plaintiff's exhibits one and two.) The Court notes that the address where substitute service occurred is the same address that Defendant uses in filing the instant motion.

Defendant's declaration to the motion to set aside is insufficient to rebut the presumption that the service was proper. Defendant's declaration states that there was no personal service but fails to challenge proper substitute service.

Similarly, Defendant fails to set forth any other valid grounds to set aside and vacate default.

Defendant's motion to set aside default and default judgment is therefore denied.

WELLS FARGO BANK, N.A. vs. ANDREA DAROCHA
Case No. CL25-11400

Plaintiff's Motion to Deem Matters Admitted

TENTATIVE RULING

THE PARTIES ARE TO APPEAR.
